

make_cdB Known Problems and Solutions

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make_cdB Known Problems and Solutions

This document describes important Cadence Change Requests (CCRs) for make_cdB and tells you how to solve or work around these problems. To find out what CCRs were fixed in this release, see the `README.txt` file in your software installation directory.

Identified in Previous Releases

- CCR 183029: make_cdB fails to detect the SPICE model generated by Spec2Spice on page 5
- CCR 94669: Use model inconsistencies between Spectre and SPICE on page 6
- CCR 29539: The slash (/) symbol in a CDL netlist is not understood by make_cdB on page 6

CCR 183029: make_cdB fails to detect the SPICE model generated by Spec2Spice

Description: When you specify a Spectre model file using the `-spectre_file_list` option, make_cdB uses Spec2Spice to translate the Spectre model file to SPICE before characterization. However, make_cdB fails to detect the SPICE model(s) generated by Spec2Spice if the input Spectre file is instantiating a device at the top level and not within the subcircuit (`subckt`). This causes make_cdB to abort with the following message:

```
ERROR: (SI-0501) make_cdb.tmp.in.spice:10: subckt <subckt_name> device
<device_name>: cannot find model
```

where:

<subckt_name> specifies the name of the subcircuit.

<device_name> specifies the name of the device at the top level.

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Solution: In the input Spectre file, remove the device from the top level and specify the updated Spectre file using the `-spectre_file_list` option of the `generate_cell_lib` command to characterize the cell.

CCR 94669: Use model inconsistencies between Spectre and SPICE

Description: When using `make_cdB` to create the cdB noise library, the following use model inconsistencies exist between Spectre® and SPICE:

- When using the `generate_cell_lib -spectre_file_list` option, you must specify the Spectre models before specifying the subcircuit in the list. When using the `generate_cell_lib -file_list` option for SPICE files, the order in which you specify these files does not matter.
- When redefining cells in the cell netlist, the Spectre netlist parser stops at the next definition of a cell and issues an error message. The SPICE netlist parser ignores the next definition of a cell and issues a warning message.

Solution: This is a limitation enforced by Spectre. However, the Spectre files are processed by the parser in a specific order, so you must define the models and subcircuit before they are used and list the files using this same order.

CCR 29539: The slash (/) symbol in a CDL netlist is not understood by make_cdB

Description: Some CDL netlists use a slash (/) symbol to separate the inputs from the outputs in the port list of a `.subckt` definition. The `make_cdB` parser does not understand this syntax.

Solution: Remove the slash (/) symbol from the CDL netlist.